

ClickUp – Growth Marketing Strategist

Early in my career I noticed the fastest way to get better was to write everything down: what worked, what failed, why a decision got made. That habit became Marketing In Action (newsletter.marketinginaction.xyz), the newsletter and system I still run today, and it's also why I default to building measured systems instead of running one-off campaigns. I've spent seven-plus years doing this across B2B and SaaS companies in Africa, North America, and Europe, usually as the first or early marketing hire, responsible for building the system before there was a team to run it.

ClickUp is solving a version of that same problem right now. Every independent review in 2026 says the same thing: you've won the breadth argument decisively, and that same depth is why new signups hit a learning curve. Brain² only compounds as a moat once someone actually reaches it, which means the real work is sequencing, not adding more surface area.

I've already built that sequencing, twice. At Reform, I resequenced a genuinely powerful, multi-feature PLG product's onboarding so a first-time user met it progressively instead of all at once, delivering an 18% lift in activation, then led a phased freemium-to-paid lifecycle sunset that converted 72% of legacy free users to paid with no hard cutover. At Marketing In Action, I run that same motion on my own self-serve funnel, positioning through checkout through lifecycle, myself. The same instinct applies to Brain² adoption: define the specific, measured event that proves it's working, the same discipline behind the 123 custom AI marketing systems I run in daily production, 31 of them published open source at github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills.

I've put together a short portfolio for this specific role: jamespraise.xyz/work/clickup.

James